P.E.N.Y

PERSONAL EXPENSE & NET-WORTH YIELD

User Guide

Using P.E.N.Y day-to-day, including Bank Sync and statement import

Version 1.9.0 · 29 October 2026

Server, Windows and mobile app editions

Part of the ALIS OS suite

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A simple guide to using P.E.N.Y day-to-day. For how to install it, see the Setup Guide (server) or the Windows Build Guide. This one is just about using the app once it's running.

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> **What's new in 1.9.0**
>
> Bank Sync is now set up entirely inside the app — nothing to change on the server or computer. You can also import a statement downloaded from any UK bank's online banking (CSV or OFX), and P.E.N.Y works out the layout by itself.

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1 Logging In

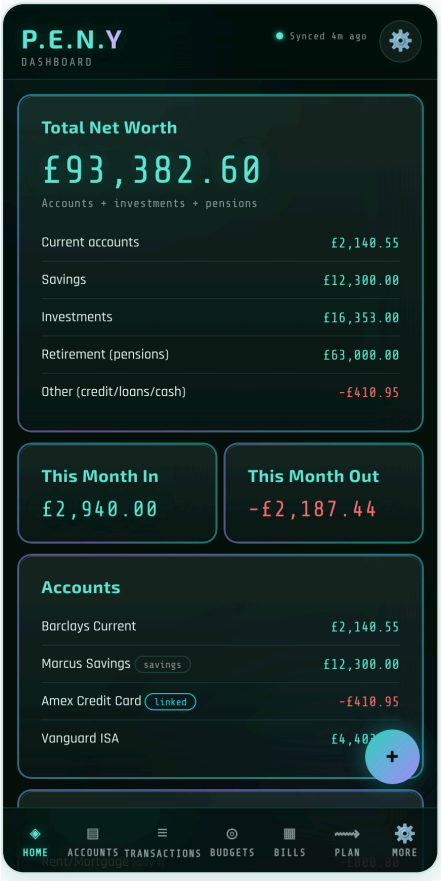
The first time you open P.E.N.Y, tap **Create one** and enter an email and a password (at least 8 characters).

> **Write down your recovery code**
> Straight after signing up you'll see a recovery code — four groups of four letters and numbers, like `6LZZ-5XNS-7JCV-6KA2`. Write it in a notebook, not a file on the same computer. It's the only way back in if you forget your password. Tick the box to confirm you've saved it, then carry on.

If more than one person uses P.E.N.Y, everyone can create their own login, and everyone's data is completely private — including their bank connections.

Forgotten your password? On the login screen, tap **Reset it** and enter your email, your recovery code and a new password.

2 The Dashboard (Home)



This is what you see when you open the app.

- **Total Net Worth** — everything added together: accounts, investments and pensions, with a breakdown underneath
- **This Month In / Out** — what's come in and gone out so far this month
- **Accounts** — a quick list of your balances
- **Upcoming Bills** — what's due soon

The dot in the top-right corner shows your bank sync: **Synced 4m ago** means up to date. Tap it to go to Bank Sync. The ⚙ cog also opens Settings.

3 Accounts and Investments

Tap **Accounts** at the bottom to see and manage your accounts.

To add an account: tap **+ Add Account**, give it a name (e.g. "Barclays Current"), choose a type (current, savings, credit card, loan, investment or cash) and enter the balance it has right now.

Accounts fed by Bank Sync show a small **linked** tag and are created for you when you connect a bank (see Chapter 6).

Investments

Further down the same screen is **Investments** — for stocks, shares, funds, or anything else that isn't a simple account balance.

To add one: tap **+ Add Investment**, give it a name, pick a type and enter its current value. If you also enter what you originally paid, P.E.N.Y works out your gain or loss.

4 Transactions, Budgets and Bills

Transactions

Tap **Transactions** to see everything you've spent or received, newest first. Use the search box to find something quickly.

To add one by hand: tap the round + button, choose the account and category, and enter the date and amount (a minus sign for spending, no minus for money coming in). Tap any transaction to edit or delete it.

Most people won't type many transactions in — Chapter 6 shows how to bring them in from your bank.

Budgets

Tap **Budgets** to compare your spending with what you planned for each category this month. Tap **+ Set a Budget**, choose a category and enter the amount.

Bills

Tap **Bills** for recurring payments — rent, subscriptions, utilities. Tap **+ Add Bill** and enter a name, amount, the day of the month it's due and how often it repeats.

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5 Plan



The bigger picture.

Cashflow Forecast – whether your balance is likely to stay healthy over the next 90 days, based on your bills and typical spending.

Pension & Investment Growth – how your pensions (violet line) and investments (cyan line) are projected to grow, with a dashed line for the combined total.

Pensions & Retirement – add each pension and P.E.N.Y combines them into a projected retirement pot and a rough monthly income.

To set this up: tap **Set Retirement Assumptions** and enter your date of birth, a withdrawal rate (4% a year is a common starting point) and your State Pension if you know it. Then tap **+ Add Pension** for each pot: its current value, your and your employer's monthly contributions, an assumed growth rate, and the age you can access it.

> **Estimates, not advice**
>
> These figures come from the numbers you enter. They're not financial advice or a guarantee – real growth depends on markets, fees and tax rules P.E.N.Y can't know about.

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6 Bringing In Your Bank Transactions

There are two ways. You can use either, or both. Both are under **More** at the bottom of the screen.

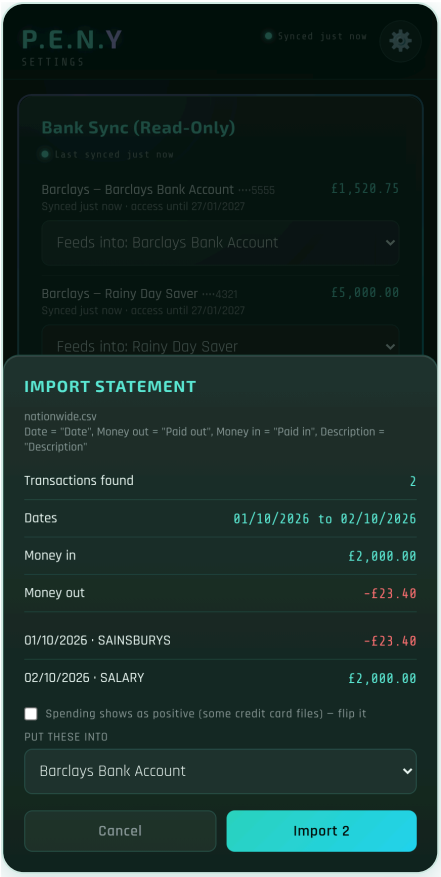
	Option 1 — Import a statement	Option 2 — Bank Sync
How it works	Download a file from your online banking and pick it in P.E.N.Y	P.E.N.Y fetches new transactions by itself
Setup	None	About 10 minutes, once
Works with	Any UK bank, Microsoft Money and Quicken files	Banks available through Enable Banking
Ongoing	Repeat whenever you like (e.g. monthly)	Re-approve at your bank about every 90 days
Best for	Simple and private – ideal to start with	Hands-off, always up to date

> **Both are read-only**
> Neither option can move money or make payments. P.E.N.Y only ever reads your transactions and balances.

Option 1 — Import a statement file (no setup)

1. Log in to your **online banking** on a computer and open the account's transactions or statements page.
2. Look for **Download**, **Export** or **Download transactions**. Choose **CSV** (sometimes called "Excel" or "spreadsheet") or **OFX** / "Microsoft Money" / "Quicken", and the dates you want. Save the file.
3. In P.E.N.Y go to **More** → **Import a Bank Statement** and tap **Choose Statement File…**
4. Check the summary: how many transactions, the dates, and money in and out. Choose which account they belong to (or create a new one) and tap **Import**.

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P.E.N.Y works out the layout by itself. It recognises the column layouts used by Barclays, HSBC, Lloyds, Halifax, NatWest, Santander, Nationwide, Monzo, Starling and most others. The top lines show which columns it used.

Already imported? Anything that's already in P.E.N.Y is skipped, so it's safe to import overlapping dates.

Credit card file shows spending as positive? Tick **flip it** before importing and check the preview looks right.

Old Microsoft Money or Quicken data? Export a QIF or OFX file from the old program and import it the same way. For QIF there's a tick box for UK-style dates.

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Option 2 — Bank Sync (automatic)

Bank Sync uses **Enable Banking**, an open banking company that connects to UK and European banks. It's **free when you only connect your own accounts**. Each person sets it up for themselves, once, in about 10 minutes. You only need a web browser.

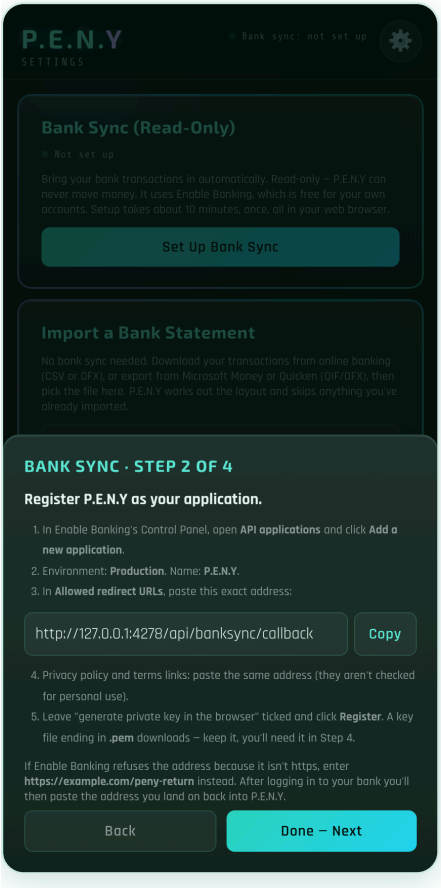
> **Before you start**
> Have your online banking login (or banking app) to hand — you'll approve access with it. Do it on the computer or device you use P.E.N.Y on.

In P.E.N.Y go to **More** → **Bank Sync** → **Set Up Bank Sync**. A short guide walks you through four steps.

Step 1 — Make a free Enable Banking login

Click the link in the guide to open Enable Banking's website, sign up with your email, and click the link in the email they send you.

Step 2 — Register P.E.N.Y as your application



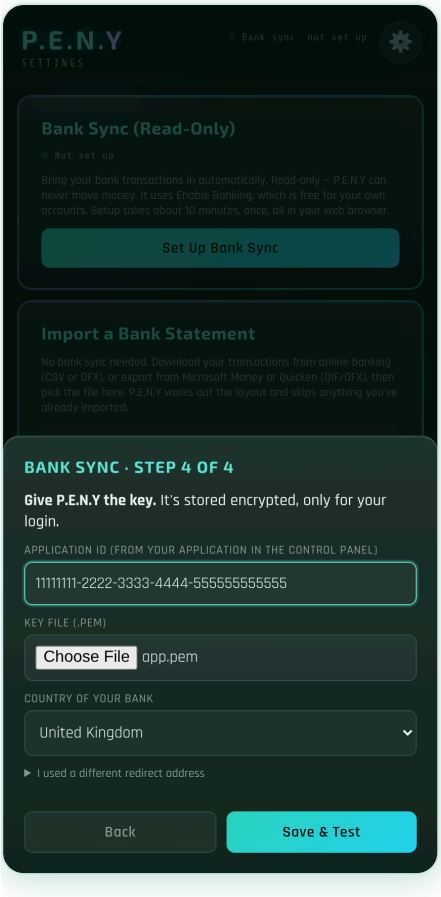
1. In Enable Banking's Control Panel open **API applications** and click **Add a new application**.
2. Choose **Production** and name it **P.E.N.Y**.
3. Tap **Copy** in P.E.N.Y and paste the address into **Allowed redirect URLs**. Paste the same address for the privacy policy and terms links.
4. Leave "generate private key in the browser" ticked and click **Register**. A **key file ending in .pem** downloads — keep it.

If it won't accept the address because it isn't https, use `https://example.com/peny-return` instead. You'll then paste one address back into P.E.N.Y after logging in to your bank (see Step 5).

Step 3 — Link your own accounts

On your new application, click **Activate by linking accounts**. Choose your bank, accept the terms and approve on your bank's page or app. Repeat for each bank you use. The application then shows **Restricted** and **Active** — that's correct, and it's what keeps it free.

Step 4 — Give P.E.N.Y the key

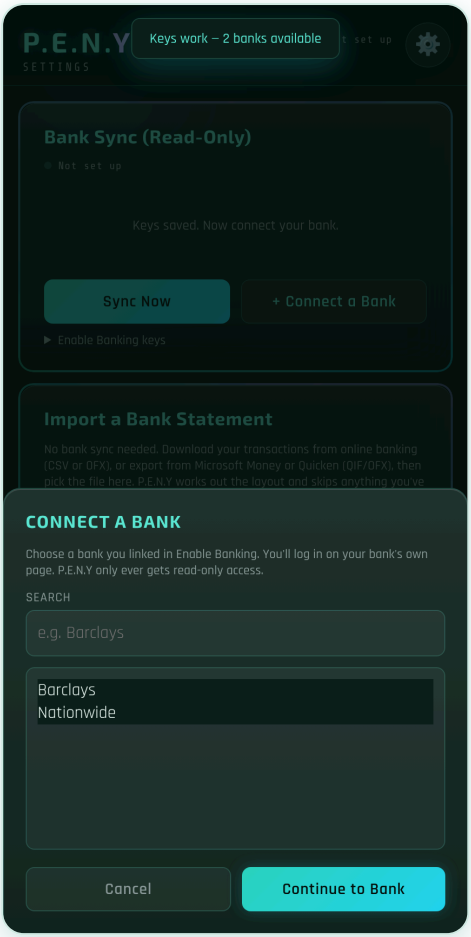


Paste the **Application ID** (the long code shown on your application in Enable Banking), pick the **.pem key file** that downloaded in Step 2, choose your country and tap **Save & Test**.

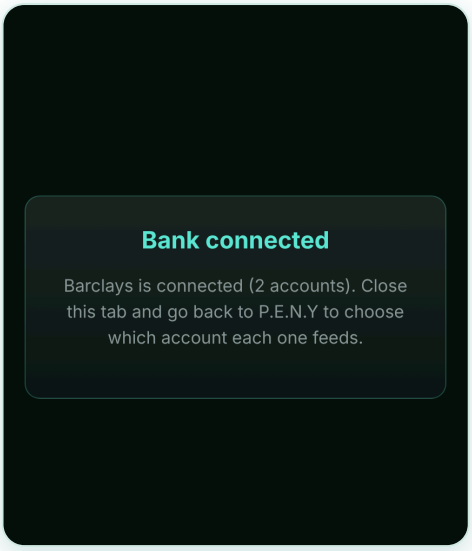
P.E.N.Y checks the key straight away and tells you if anything's wrong. The key is stored **encrypted** and only for your login.

If you used the example.com address in Step 2, open **I used a different redirect address** and enter it there.

Step 5 — Connect your bank



Search for your bank and tap Continue to Bank



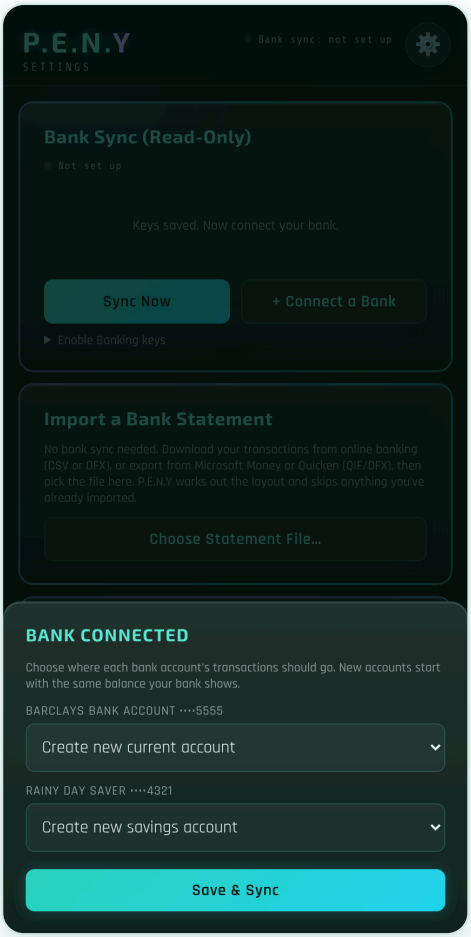
After approving at your bank you'll see this page

Your bank's own login page opens in your web browser. Log in and approve **read-only** access. When you see **Bank connected**, close that tab and go back to P.E.N.Y – it moves on by itself.

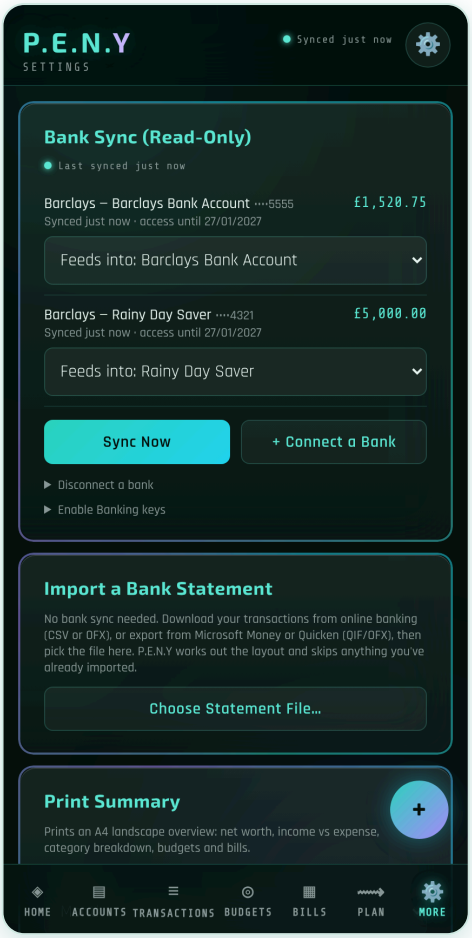
Ended up on a page that didn't load? (This is expected if you used the example.com address.) Copy the whole address from that page's address bar, open **Ended up on a page that didn't load?** in P.E.N.Y, paste it in and tap **Finish Connecting**.

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Step 6 — Choose where each account goes



Pick a new or existing P.E.N.Y account for each bank account



Connected and synced — balances shown on the right

For each account at your bank, choose **Create new …** (P.E.N.Y suggests current, savings or credit card from the account's name), **Add to existing** one of your accounts, or **Don't import this one**. Tap **Save & Sync**.

New accounts start with the **same balance your bank shows**, and the last 90 days of transactions come in.

Day to day

- P.E.N.Y syncs by itself when you open it, at most every 6 hours (banks limit how often they can be checked). Tap **Sync Now** any time.
- Pending card payments appear once the bank has finished processing them.
- Banks ask you to **re-approve about every 90 days**. When the top-right says **Bank access expired**, go to **More → Bank Sync → + Connect a Bank** and choose the same bank. Your accounts reconnect where they were.
- To stop syncing one bank, open **Disconnect a bank**. To remove everything, open **Enable Banking keys → Remove All**. Transactions already imported always stay.

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If something goes wrong

What you see	What to do
"Enable Banking did not accept your Application ID and key file"	Check the Application ID was copied fully and that you picked the .pem file from the same application. Use **Enable Banking keys → Change Keys** to try again.
"The return address is not on your application's list"	In Enable Banking, add the address exactly as P.E.N.Y shows it in Step 2 (use the Copy button).
The page after your bank login doesn't load	Copy the address from the address bar and paste it into **Ended up on a page that didn't load?**
Your bank isn't in the list, or no accounts come back	Make sure you did Step 3 (linking accounts) for that bank. If your bank isn't offered at all, use Option 1 – import a statement.
"Bank access expired"	Reconnect that bank (Day to day, above). Nothing is lost.
"Your bank has limited how often it can be checked"	Wait a few hours and try again.
"Could not find the Date and Amount columns"	The file isn't a transactions download. Try the bank's OFX / "Microsoft Money" option instead of CSV.

Your privacy

Your transactions are stored only in your own P.E.N.Y. Your Enable Banking key is encrypted and only used for your login. Other people using the same P.E.N.Y can't see your bank connections. Enable Banking passes data between your bank and P.E.N.Y; it can't move money.

7 More (Settings)

- **Bank Sync** – set up, sync, connect or disconnect banks (Chapter 6)
- **Import a Bank Statement** – CSV, OFX or QIF files (Chapter 6)
- **Print Summary** – a month, year or 5-year summary of net worth, income and spending, budgets and bills on one A4 landscape page
- **Security** – turn on 2FA (a 6-digit code from an authenticator app, as well as your password)
- **Your Data** – export everything as a full backup (JSON), a spreadsheet (CSV) or QIF, or restore a P.E.N.Y backup

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8 A Few Tips

- The round + button in the bottom-right adds whatever makes sense for the screen you're on.
- Tap any item in a list (a transaction, account, pension or investment) to edit or delete it.
- Everything you enter stays in your own P.E.N.Y. Nothing goes anywhere else unless you turn on Bank Sync, and even then P.E.N.Y can only read.
- Take a **Full Backup** from **More** → **Your Data** every so often and keep it somewhere safe.
- If you're unsure what a figure means, the small grey text under most numbers explains it.

> **Help**
> P.E.N.Y is part of the ALIS OS suite. If something doesn't look right, a screenshot of the screen plus what you were trying to do is the quickest way to get it sorted.

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